Dillon Prendergast

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DevSecOps engineer specializing in secure automation and reproducible data pipelines for cybersecurity and bioinformatics systems. Experienced in Docker, CI/CD, and scalable Python API development. Focused on reliable systems with measurable operational impact.

Experience

Mercor Intelligence (formerly Sepal AI) — Remote
Forward Deployed Engineer (Contract) — *August 2025 – Present*

- Build automation workflows across a distributed bench of 250+ STEM experts and engineers, translating model-training requirements into reproducible software pipelines and review processes that support weekly delivery of 1,000+ training problems.
- Built reproducible bioinformatics data-prep automation for offline workflows, integrating safety benchmarks into CI/CD and infrastructure-as-code paths to reduce manual curation.
- Led offline-ready Nextflow/nf-core pipelines and containerized Python exploit labs for reproducing, patching, and regression-testing live CVEs in deterministic, air-gapped environments.

Johns Hopkins University Applied Physics Lab — Laurel, MD
Cybersecurity Software Engineer — *June 2020 – July 2025*

- Redesigned a classified system's backend architecture from C to Python/FastAPI/SQLAlchemy, enabling new analytics APIs and faster integration with modern front-ends.
- Automated cybersecurity dashboard validation with Selenium and CI/CD hooks across release cycles, reducing manual validation effort by 70%.
- Created a text-extraction and enrichment pipeline using NLTK + regex, deployed via Streamlit with SQLite to recompile years of unstructured research data and surface long-term patterns.
- Led cybersecurity evaluations for a national defense sponsor, delivering monthly risk reports that prioritized remediation and informed program-level decisions.

Projects

DNASign (Open-Source Genomic Data Integrity Reference Implementation) — *March 2025 – July 2025*

- Proposed and secured an internal research grant, then co-developed DNASign as an open-source reference implementation for genomic data integrity (github.com/JHUAPL/DNASign).
- Designed and tested a pseudo-implementation that applies cryptographic signing and verification to FASTA/FASTQ artifacts, improving provenance and tamper detection in bioinformatics pipelines.

E-Commerce Data Automation (Trading Card Pipeline) — *January 2025 – July 2025*

- Built a Google Apps Script with custom parsers to normalize titles, attributes, and pricing from images/URLs into structured eBay listings, automating 100+ monthly transactions at 98% accuracy.

Education

Florida State University — Tallahassee, FL
Master of Science in Computer Science — *January 2019 – May 2020*
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science — *August 2015 – December 2018*

Technical Skills

Languages: Python, JavaScript/TypeScript, SQL, Bash, Regex
Frameworks: FastAPI, Django, Angular, Streamlit, SQLAlchemy, Pandas, Selenium
DevOps & Cloud: Docker, GitLab CI/CD, AWS, Modal
Security: MITRE ATT&CK, DoDCAR, Zero Trust, CVE analysis
Specialties: Automation, Containerization, Data Integration, Web Scraping

Languages

English: Native | **German**: B1 | **Brazilian Portuguese**: A2